

Part 1 — Vocabulary

New words from Lesson 2 · Human Skills

toxic <i>/ˈtɒksɪk/</i>	ТОКСИЧНИЙ	harmful to people around them <i>"A toxic team member can destroy morale even if they hit all their targets."</i>
trustworthiness <i>/ˈtrʌstwɜːðɪnəs/</i>	надійність	quality of being reliable and honest <i>"We have zero metrics to measure someone's trustworthiness."</i>
empathy <i>/ˈempəθi/</i>	емпатія	ability to understand others' feelings <i>"Good leaders need empathy — they must understand what their team is going through."</i>
confrontation <i>/ˌkɒnfrənˈteɪʃn/</i>	конфронтація	a direct, difficult conversation about a conflict <i>"How to have effective confrontations is one of the hardest human skills to learn."</i>
peer review <i>/pɪə riˈvjuː/</i>	оцінка колег	evaluation by colleagues at the same level <i>"Peer reviews are a great way to identify your most trusted team members."</i>
morale <i>/məˈrɑːl/</i>	моральний дух	confidence and enthusiasm of a group <i>"One toxic person can seriously damage the morale of the entire team."</i>
promote <i>/prəˈməʊt/</i>	підвищувати	to move someone to a higher position <i>"We keep promoting people who hit numbers without checking if they can actually lead."</i>
pretend <i>/prɪˈtend/</i>	вдавати	to act as if something is true when it isn't <i>"Don't pretend to agree if you have concerns — that damages trust over time."</i>
influence <i>/ˈɪnfluəns/</i>	вплив / впливати	the power to affect others' thinking or behaviour <i>"Great leaders influence people through trust and respect, not through authority."</i>
valuable <i>/ˈvæljuəbl/</i>	цінний	extremely useful or important <i>"Every pitch can be a source of valuable learning, even if you don't close the deal."</i>

reliable

/rɪˈlaɪəbl/

надійний

consistently good and dependable

"A reliable team member delivers what they promise, when they promise it."

trustworthy

/ˈtrʌstwɜːði/

гідний довіри

able to be trusted completely

"She's the most trustworthy person on the team — everyone goes to her when things go wrong."

pet peeve

informal

особиста
дратівниця

something that personally irritates you more than others

"My pet peeve is back-to-back meetings with no time to think in between."

negligible

/ˈneglɪdʒəbl/

мізерний

so small it can be ignored

"The difference in performance was negligible — but the difference in trust was huge."

embody

/ɪmˈbɒdi/

втілювати

to be a living example of something

"The best natural leaders embody the company values better than anyone else."

Part 2 — Phrases

Expressions and collocations from Lesson 2

when the chips are down

коли настають важкі часи

in a difficult or critical situation — when things get tough

"You find out who you can really trust when the chips are down."

hit your numbers

виконати план / досягти показників

to achieve your performance targets — KPIs, OKRs, sales goals

"She always hits her numbers, but nobody on the team trusts her."

point to the same person

всі показують на одну й ту саму людину

when everyone immediately agrees on who fits a description

"Ask who the most trusted person is — they'll all point to the same person."

at stake

під загрозою

at risk of being lost or damaged

"There's a lot at stake when you pitch to investors — prepare carefully."

as opposed to

на відміну від / а не

used to contrast two things — instead of / rather than

"Focus on user retention, as opposed to just acquiring new users."

rules of engagement

правила взаємодії

clear agreed norms for how people work together

"We established clear rules of engagement for hybrid work — set office days, core meeting hours."

psychological safety

психологічна безпека

feeling safe to speak up and take risks without fear of punishment

"Without psychological safety, people hide problems instead of solving them."

cognitive trust

когнітивна довіра

trust based on someone's competence and reliability — you trust what they can do

"Cognitive trust is built through consistency — doing what you say you'll do."

affective trust

афективна довіра

trust based on emotional connection and genuine care for each other

"Affective trust takes longer to build remotely — it needs intentional human moments."

Part 3 — Grammar Notes

Two common patterns worth knowing

Using 'they' for a person of unknown gender

Коли ми говоримо про людину і не знаємо або не хочемо вказувати — він чи вона — використовуємо they / them / their. Це сучасна стандартна норма англійської.

- Rule** When referring to a single person whose gender is unknown or irrelevant, use they / them / their instead of he or she.
- Why** English has no neutral singular pronoun. 'He or she' is clunky and outdated. 'They' is widely accepted — including in formal business writing.

Examples:

- Sinek:** *"Go ask any team who the difficult person is — and they'll all point to the same person."*
- Google article:** *'Anyone starting a new job needs rapport — make sure they have a buddy to help them.'*
- Natural:** *"A new hire needs time to settle in. Make sure they have a buddy."*
- Avoid:** *"Make sure he or she has a buddy to help him or her." — too clunky X*

□ This use of singular 'they' is centuries old — Shakespeare used it. It is standard in modern business English.

Assign — not 'give' — for roles and responsibilities

Коли ми офіційно призначаємо когось на роль, задачу або відповідальність — використовуємо assign, а не give. Give — передати фізично або неформально. Assign — офіційне призначення.

assign (v.) to officially give someone a role, task, or responsibility

Structure assign something to someone OR assign someone something

Examples:

- Google article:** *"New starters are all assigned an onboarding buddy." (NOT: given a buddy)*
- Work context:** *"I assigned the project to Maria — she's responsible for the delivery."*
- Avoid:** *"I gave the project to Maria." — sounds informal / like a physical handover X*
- Also correct:** *"Maria was assigned to lead the Q3 campaign."*
- Related:** *assignment (n.) — "This is your assignment for next week."*

□ Related verbs: allocate (resources), delegate (tasks downward), appoint (someone to a formal role).